



George Henry Chatham

1887 – 1916

Civilian Research

		Source of data
Casualty Name	George Henry Chatham	CWGC entry
Date of Birth	Jul-Sep 1887 He was bpt 14/9/1887, St Mary Harrow It looks like they lived in [Church of England Fields] Greenhill	FreeBMD and GRO (General Register Office) Original bpt register on Ancestry
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	23/11/1916	
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	29	
Marital Status	Single as far as I can see. I have found no references to him marrying.	Source checked: FreeBMD And it would be mentioned in remembrances/obituaries I'm sure
Children (if any)	None as I can't find a marriage	

Occupation prior to Call up	Bank Cashier at Parrs Bank, Wembley Branch From about 1904 he worked for Parrs Bank [circa age 17]	Info from Nat West Group Remembers https://www.natwestgroupremembers.com/our-fallen/our-fallen-ww1/c/george-chatham.html Source: Nat West Group Remembers 1911 Census lists him as a Bank Cashier, from FMP
Parents	James Henry and Jane Rebecca Chatham	CWGC entry and various censuses as seen on FMP
Listed Address(s)	In a 1917 newspaper report: "of High Street, Harrow" 1911, 68 High Street 1901, Wolsey House, Harrow (what?) It is listed next to a boy's boarding school on the High St, Harrow 1891 the family lived at 10 West Street, Harrow. George was 3	See below 1911 Census as seen on FMP 1901 Census as seen on FMP 1891 Census as seen on FMP
Parents /Fathers occupation	On the 1911 census he is a Bootmaker and Dealer at 68 High Street, Harrow. I'm guessing they lived above the shop? They were married Jul-Sep Qtr 1877 Mother dies between Oct -Dec 1914	1911 census as seen on FMP Source: FreeBMD Registrar General's indexes to BMD. See Notes
Brothers and Sisters	Jeannie Felton Chatham, 31 (married but married name not given on census) Jessie Bertha Chatham, 27 Eva Annie Chatham, 25 Hilda Lilian Chatham, 21 Edward Felton Chatham, 16 Robert Felton Chatham, 13 Further - found these siblings (not listed on 1911 census): William James Felton Chatham, bn 1881 Edith Emily, bn 1878	Ages correct at time of 1911 Census as seen on FMP. If there were older siblings they may have been living elsewhere George was living at home and aged 23 in 1911 Source: General Register Office Ditto
Years at John Lyon School	He was at the John Lyon School in 1903	
Obituary	The Harrow Observer, 21/9/1917. 10 months after his death.	Have saved a copy. See image below.

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	CHATHAM G.H.
CWGC Reference	Second Lieutenant George Henry Chatham War Casualty Details 1543343 CWGC
Age	29
DoD	23-Nov-16
Rank	2 Lt
Regiment	Royal Fusiliers 10th Bn
	THIEPVAL MEMORIAL
Location	Somme, France
Military details	Son of the late James Henry and Jane Rebecca Chatham. Second Lieutenant George Henry Chatham (often misspelled as Chathem) was killed in action on November 23, 1916, at the age of 29. He served with the Royal Fusiliers (City of London Regiment). He was killed on the battlefields of the Somme in northern France. His death occurred during the brutal winter operations immediately following the official end of the primary Battle of the Somme. The region was a frozen, muddy wasteland plagued by continuous trench warfare, artillery shelling, and local combat actions to secure tactical positions. Like many who fell on the devastated Somme battlefields, his original resting place was lost to subsequent fighting, or his remains could not be individually identified. He is officially remembered and commemorated by the Commonwealth War Graves Commission on the massive Thiepval Memorial to the Missing in the Somme region of France. Before answering the call to serve, Chatham lived in London and worked for Parr's Bank at their Wembley branch from around 1904. He left his banking career to enlist following the outbreak of the war, moving up through the ranks from Sergeant to be commissioned as a Second Lieutenant. He is remembered on the NatWest Group Remembers corporate archive

Story of Sacrifice

George Henry Chatham (1887–1916)

George's life began in Harrow, where he attended the Lower School of John Lyon and played cricket for the school's First Eleven. He later built a career as a bank cashier before leaving civilian life to serve with the Royal Fusiliers during the First World War.

Civilian Life

George Henry Chatham was born in 1887 and baptised at St Mary's Church, Harrow, on 14 September that year. He was the son of James Henry Chatham, a bootmaker and dealer, and Jane Rebecca Chatham. The family lived in Harrow, and by 1911 George was living at home at 68 High Street with his parents and several of his brothers and sisters.

George attended the Lower School of John Lyon, and a 1903 school photograph is believed to show him as a 15-year-old pupil. He was also a member of the school's Cricket First Eleven in 1903.

Around 1904, at about the age of 17, George began working for Parr's Bank. By the 1911 Census he was employed as a bank cashier, and his place of work was Parr's Bank's Wembley branch.

Military Life

Following the outbreak of the First World War, George left his position at the bank and joined the army. He initially served with the 10th Battalion, Royal Fusiliers, as a Sergeant, with the service number 49. He was subsequently commissioned as a Second Lieutenant in the Royal Fusiliers. The 10th Battalion, Royal Fusiliers, was known as the Stockbrokers' Battalion and included men from London's financial sector. The battalion served in France and took part in fighting including the Somme and Ypres.

George was killed in action on 23 November 1916, aged 29, during the fighting on the Somme. A report published in the Harrow Observer in September 1917 recorded that he had been reported missing after going out with a bombing party, and that no member of the party had been heard from afterwards.

George has no known grave and is commemorated on the Thiepval Memorial to the Missing on the Somme in France.

Photos



Whole Lower School of John Lyon - School Photo 1903



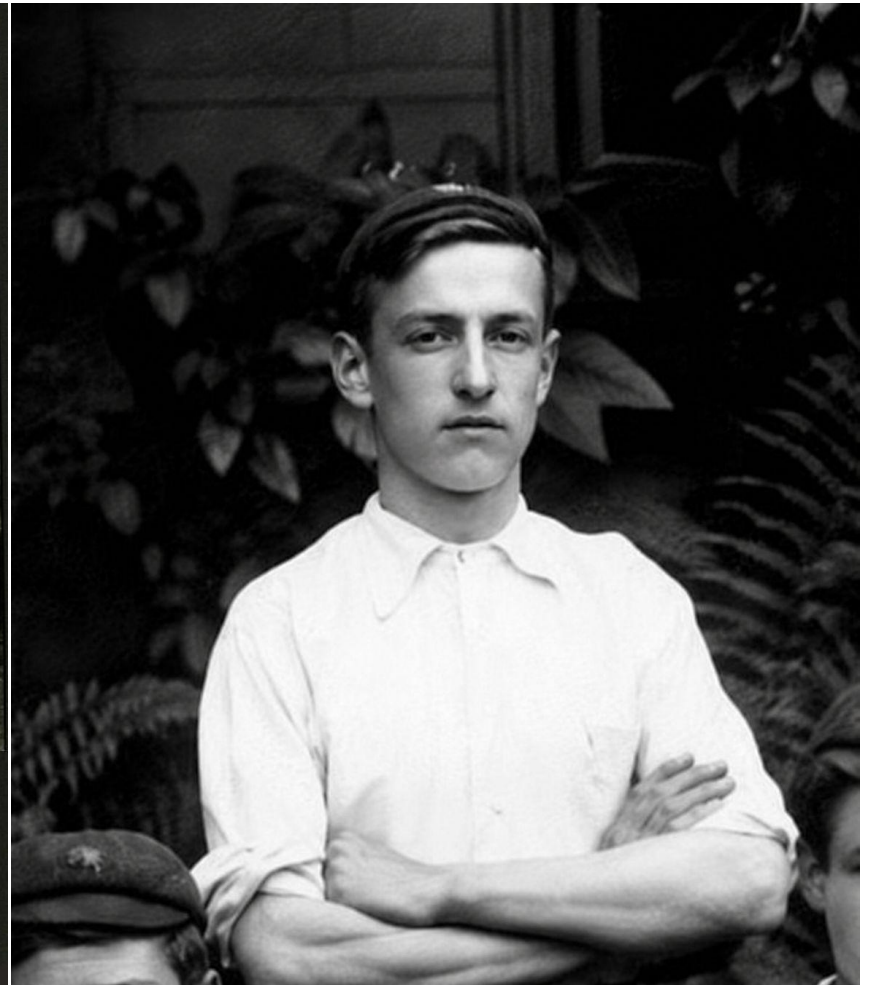
Thought to be George Chatham 1903



Possibly Chatham from 1903 School Photo



Possibly Chatham from 1903 School Photo AI Enhanced



Cricket 1st Eleven 1903 – George Chatham back row top left

Notes and Clippings

Harrow Observer 21 st September 1917	
SECOND LIEUT. G. CHATHAM. Mr. J. H. Chatham, of High-street, Harrow, has received the news that his son Second Lieut. George Chatham is presumed to have been killed. He was reported missing last November and no news has been received since. He went out with a bombing party and not a single member has been heard of from that night. There is still hope that he may be a prisoner of war.	Second Lieut. G. Chatham Mr. J.H. Chatham, of High-street, Harrow, has received the the news that his son Second Lieut. George Chatham is presuled to have been killed. He was reported missing last November and no news has been received since. He went out with a bombing party and not a single member has been heard of from that night. There is still hope that he may be a prisoner of war.

Imperial War Museum

<https://livesofthefirstworldwar.iwm.org.uk/lifestory/900163>

Lives of the First World War

We remember: George Henry Chatham

<https://livesofthefirstworldwar.iwm.org.uk/lifestory/900163>

1887 birth United Kingdom Source:7479616

1887

service British Army Serjeant 49 Royal Fusiliers 10th Battalion

Source:900163

service British Army Second Lieutenant Royal Fusiliers

Source:900163

1916 death Source:7479616

23rd November 1916

Burial: Thiepval Memorial CWGC Cemetery/Memorial Somme
France Source:7479616

Nat West Bank Our First World War fallen: George Chatham	https://www.natwestgroupremembers.com/our-fallen/our-fallen-ww1/c/george-chatham.html
George Chatham Bank: Parr's Bank Place of work: Wembley branch Died: 23 November 1916 George Henry Chatham was born in 1887, the son of James Henry Chatham, a bootmaker, and his wife Jane Rebecca. From about 1904 he worked for Parr's Bank. During the First World War Chatham left his job at the bank's Wembley branch to join the army. Second Lieutenant George Henry Chatham of the Royal Fusiliers was killed in action on the Somme on 23 November 1916. He was 29 years old.	

Other research

School life – From a photo dated 1903 - we know that George Chatham was at John Lyon in 1903 and played in the Cricket 1st Eleven team.

Someone online states that his mother died on the 26/11/1914 so before he died and would explain newspaper cutting that only refers to his father. I haven't been able to confirm this exact date, however the death of Jane Rebecca Chatham, aged 59, is registered in the Hendon registration district in the December Qtr (ie Oct, Nov or Dec) 1914. I make mention of her death as it would have been a significant event in his life (I would have thought).

The following doesn't pertain to the WW1 record but just to tidy things up - his father died 23/12/1920 at St Barts Hospital. He lived at 44 Roxborough Park, Harrow. His effects were left to Edward Felton Chatham (who we've seen previously in censuses), an actuary. Taken from Index to England & Wales Probate Calendar on Ancestry.

The following is AI research. And it includes links to confirm it's accurate

□ An Original "Stockbroker": (I believe the battalion was called the Stockbrokers Battalion) George Chatham originally enlisted into the 10th Battalion as an enlisted soldier, holding the rank of Sergeant (Service Number 49). This exceptionally low service number indicates he was one of the very first men to volunteer for the battalion when it was formed in London in late August/September 1914.

[1] This is from Lives of the First World War: <https://livesofthefirstworldwar.iwm.org.uk/lifestory/900163>

“Bank Staff in the Stockbrokers' Battalion - 10th Royal Fusiliers. Remembering the lives of bankers who served in the 10th Battalion of the Royal Fusiliers, known as the "Stockbrokers' Battalion". Raised in the financial sector of London in 1914, they landed in Boulogne in July 1915 and they saw action in many battles including The Somme and Ypres.”

Remembering the lives of bankers who served in the 10th Battalion of the Royal Fusiliers, known as the "Stockbrokers' Battalion". Raised in the financial sector of London in 1914, they landed in Boulogne in July 1915 and they saw action in many battles including The Somme and Ypres.

Commission to Officer: Demonstrating leadership capability, he was later discharged from the ranks to accept an officer's commission as a Second Lieutenant within his own regiment. From: <https://www.natwestgrouppremembers.com/our-fallen/our-fallen-ww1/c/george-chatham.html>